Another such account in the legendary Mark Twain's travels in India narrates a tale of a telegraphic message from someone at a station in the jungles of Bengal to the main station at Calcutta of a tiger eating a station manager !

> After a while we stopped at a little wooden coop of a station just within the curtain of the sombre jungle, a place with a deep and dense forest of great trees and scrub and vines all about it. The Royal Bengal tiger is in great force there (a remote station in Bengal), and is very bold and unconventional. From this lonely little station, a message once went to the railway manager in Calcutta: 'Tiger eating station master on front porch; telegraph instructions.' [102]

Tigers on the Bombay Railway Line

There's an interesting mention of a tiger attack three years before the rail lines took shape, at Bhandup, injuring passers-by.

> 9 October 1850—A tiger at Bandoop leaped upon the mail cart and upset it, and the garry-wallah was a little injured.

The mail cart road mentioned is none other than the Agra Road that later became LBS Road, which stands even today.

Another report dated 25 January 1863 states that a tiger was shot and killed by two natives at Mahim, near the railway station. [10 3]

THE DIVINE HOLE OF TALGARIA STATION

A Sacred Sati Spot That Changed Railway Alignment

This is a story of how a hollow ditch at a small station of Talgaria (today's Jharkhand) proved to be a problem for early railway engineers. The 'divine hole', as referred to in records, was once used as a sati site and was a popular place. Crowds of believers visited it even after a railway alignment and the station platform crossed over it and railway engineers kept it the way it was, just covering it with metal plates so as not to hurt the religious sentiments of the people.

The site was the talk of railway engineers and it finds mention in a photograph in a popular British rail journal of the day. *The Railway Magazine* , a monthly British railway periodical published in London since